1. Prime Contractor and Subcontracting Requirements: Would the contractor be eligible to serve as the prime contractor while partnering with an established, qualified small-business subcontractor to perform the specialized document and media destruction services, provided the arrangement complies with applicable limitations on subcontracting?

The prime must have an FCL at the highest classification level for the scope of work to be performed. Our contract is with the prime. If they use a sub, that is a contract between the prime and sub. If the sub requires access to classified, they would need an FCL as well. Additionally, any COMSEC, and OPSEC requirements that need to be flowed-down to the sub, must be authorized in writing by the KO.

2. Security Requirements: Must the prime contractor independently possess a facility security clearance, or may the required security clearances, certifications, specialized equipment, and installation access be provided through an appropriately qualified subcontractor?

Both Prime and subcontractors must meet the security requirements.

3. Performance Requirements: The PWS references monthly services in Section 3 and biweekly services in the Performance Requirements Summary. Could you confirm the intended service frequency?

It will be monthly.

4. Contract Duration and Quantities: Are the estimated annual electronic media destruction quantities intended to apply to the six-month performance period identified in the PWS?

Yes, we intend to shred the majority of the material during the short-term contract spread out over the six-month period, and then maintain a regular drum beat of shredding in the long term contract.

5. Would a small-business prime contractor be eligible if all classified material handling and destruction were performed by an appropriately cleared subcontractor, or must the prime independently possess a facility security clearance?

No, both Prime and subcontractors must possess appropriate clearances (please see above).

6. Would the Navy consider an arrangement in which the prime manages contract administration, scheduling, quality assurance, and invoicing while the qualified subcontractor performs the physical destruction, provided the arrangement complies with FAR 52.219-14?

The government will only directly work with the prime contractor (the prime is responsible for coordinating the work that is being done through the subcontractor).

7. Are there additional facility clearance, personnel clearance, or security sponsorship requirements that would apply to the prime contractor?

The FCL is comprised of an Entity Eligibility (for the company itself, including Key Managerial Personal), and Personnel Clearance (PCL).

8. Could you clarify any mandatory equipment certifications, installation-access requirements, and courier credentials beyond those described in the draft PWS?

Equipment must meet specifications for destruction levels listed for secure document, media, and device destruction per PWS. For installation access, the FCL is comprised of an Entity Eligibility (for the company itself), and Personnel Clearance (PCL).

9. Does the Navy anticipate issuing a formal solicitation following this market survey, and is there an estimated timeframe?

Yes, it is the intention to post a formal solicitation in the weeks following this sources sought notice.

10. Two items would benefit from clarification: (a) PWS 3.1 states monthly service, while the Performance Requirements Summary is titled "Bi-Weekly Shredding Services"; and (b) PWS 3.3.2 and 4.2.1 require Secret clearances for each employee, but the notice does not state whether a DD Form 254 and a contractor Facility Clearance will be issued, which determines which firms can sponsor clearances.

The requirement is monthly (a solicitation would have an updated PWS). In a non-regular shred event, the government would give the contractor 14 days' notice. A DD254 will be issued as part of the solicitation(s), additionally, an FCL is a requirement.

11. Stating the expected monthly volume (pounds of paper, number of hard drives and devices) and the number of pier-side events per year would help offerors size equipment and price accurately. Allowing the Government to verify NSA/CSS EPL compliance through the equipment model numbers listed in the quote would also simplify evaluation.

This is a comment rather than a question; however, referring to the PWS shred events are done by bin/truck and devices are done by each (not weight).

12. How many locations and time frame of time to retrieve shredded material bins ex: weekly monthly etc?

Please refer to the PWS for clarification of locations and time frame (PWS 3.2 Service Window and PWS 3.3 Service Locations).